

State Administrator's Report

February 19, 2026

Important Announcements and Meetings

On February 4, Jared DeMarinis attended the opening of the exhibition “Ballot Boxes of the Americas: History and Symbols of Democracy” at the headquarters of the Organization of American States (OAS). Maryland provided three pieces for the exhibit. One was a 1800’s glass ballot box from Carroll County.

The NASED (National Association of State Election Directors) Winter Conference occurred on February 1-3. There were public presentations on the use of AI by election offices, VVSG updates, USPS plans for the election year, and a SAVE system briefing.

On February 11, Jared DeMarinis spoke at a League of Women Voters of Anne Arundel County regarding the upcoming election, tactics to combat disinformation and increase voter participation.

Legislation

All of the departmental bills have been heard by the respective committees. Additionally, Jared DeMarinis and Katie Berry did an election briefing in front of the Labor, Elections, and Government committee. It was well received.

Candidacy and Campaign Finance (CCF) Division

Between January 14 and February 13, 2026, 174 new committees were established.

2026 Gubernatorial Elections

SBE has filed 410 candidates so far. The candidate filing deadline is February 24, 2026, at 9:00 PM.

Every candidate who filed in 2025 must file another financial disclosure statement in 2026 in order to appear on the ballot. SBE has continued to send notices to those candidates. The candidates have until the withdrawal deadline, February 26, 2026 to file a current financial disclosure statement.

MD CRIS

The first report in the new MD CRIS system was the Annual 2026 Report, due on Wednesday, January 21, at 11:59 PM.

Annual 2026 Filing Performance:

- Total Filers Assigned the 2026 Annual Report: 2,119
- On-Time Filing: 86%
- Total Filed: 93% (1,814 on-time filers, 109 late filers, 196 non-filers)

From January 15th to January 22nd, 2026, leading up to the filing of the Annual 2026 Report, the CCF Division hosted a virtual Filing Hotline Support via Zoom for filers. The feedback for this open Filing Hotline Support was overwhelmingly positive.

Filing Hotline Support:

- Total Callers: 1,044
- Total Assistance Time: 2,798 minutes, equivalent to 46 hours and 38 minutes of direct support
- Peake Activity: Jan 21st with 340 callers and 887 minutes of support

Public Outreach

The CCF Division conducted 32 training sessions, offering hands-on instruction to 541 participants. These sessions were designed to ensure that every user is well-prepared for their submissions by covering essential aspects of the reporting process and providing direct technical support. On Monday, February 10, the candidacy staff was invited to speak at the African American Democratic Leadership Council. The presentation focused on the requirements for filing for office in the 2026 gubernatorial election, aimed at candidates or potential candidates.

Starting on November 10, CCF executed a proactive outreach campaign to ensure compliance among businesses employing lobbyists. A notice was sent to entities registered with the Maryland State Ethics Commission but not yet with the State Board of Elections. Due to this outreach, 245 businesses have since successfully registered on the Maryland Business Contribution Disclosure System (MD BCDS).

On January 12, 2026, we hosted a focused press event and showcase for members of the media, university representatives, and independent researchers to demonstrate the capabilities of the newly upgraded MD CRIS and MD BCDS. This event has a strong turnout with 23 attendees participating both in person and virtually.

On February 9, 2026, Allen Norfleet was a featured speaker at a journalism class at the Philip Merrill School of Journalism at the University of Maryland. The main topic of discussion was Maryland Campaign Finance law.

Public Financing (PF)

Currently, there are 52 active public financed (PF) committees.

As of February 12, twenty-three public financed candidates are Certified/Qualified. One even maxed out on the initial Matching Fund Report (MFR).

Currently, there is \$10,587,985.42 in the State Fair Campaign Fund. This means the program can fully fund 2 Primary candidates and 1 candidate in the General. No additional funding is needed.

Enforcement

Listed below are the civil penalties paid in January 2025. The total amount collected is \$675:

- a. Carmody, Jack for District 8 - \$125 - Failure to include authority line or authority line is

insufficient.

- b. LeCole, Kenisha for Wicomico County Board Of Education (District 7)-Civil penalty - \$50 - Failure to include authority line or authority line is insufficient.
- c. Finoh, Sia Friends of - \$500 - Failure to maintain account books and records, Failure to include authority line or authority line is insufficient.

Communications

Social Media presence remains a priority to ensure votes know their elected officials are their trusted sources for election information.

We are in the final stages of planning for an aggressive voter outreach campaign focusing on voter education. The campaign includes a landing page that allows people to upload the election calendar to an individual's phone and provides information on how to register to vote, become an election judge and methods of voting. There will continue to be paid outreach focusing on election judge recruitment and voter education leading up to the 2026 Primary and General elections. There will also be resources provided to local boards for the use of organic social media content to supplement the outreach campaign. Internally, we will utilize their own organic social media content to target mis/disinformation through voter education materials and videos.

LBEs had the opportunity to order a new 2026 "Maryland Voter" sticker celebrating the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence in place of the typical "I Voted" sticker.

The SBE Official Voter Resource app is in testing stages. We are hoping to launch the app later this month which will be a wonderful resource for voters during the 2026 elections.

Social Media Highlights

So far in 2026, we have seen a large increase in social media engagement. We have gained 558 new Facebook followers and 343 new Instagram followers. Our Instagram posts have reached almost 600 interactions, while our Facebook page has seen almost 1.3M interactions.

One organic Facebook post featuring Election Dates was viewed over 200,000 times, liked by almost 3,000 people, and shared over 1,000 times.

Our ads have also been drawing in a noteworthy number of engagements. The current ads we have running feature information encouraging voters to sign up to be election judges.

Election Management & Compliance

Correctional Facility Voting

Per Election Law Article, §1-303.2(e), we submitted the annual JCR report to the Senate Education, Energy, and the Environment (EEE) Committee and the House Ways and Means Committee regarding the registration and voting activities in the detention centers of Maryland for 2025.

Preparations for the 2026 election cycle are currently underway. We have been meeting with the

Department of Public Safety and Correctional Services (DPSCS) and local detention center staff to discuss our previous successes and how we can improve our efforts this election cycle. One of the ideas discussed was to explore options for providing candidate information through non-partisan sources. Lastly, we recently received a list of resource fairs that will be held this year. We are making plans to attend some of these to increase our voter outreach and education efforts.

We are preparing the materials for the voting packet procurement. Our voting packets include a Hello Voter Letter, Voter Registration Application, Mail-in Ballot Application, and a postage paid return envelope. Prince George's and Montgomery Counties will receive bilingual voting information and materials (English/Spanish).

As we did last election cycle, we will be using a SmartSheet that contains all of the information we use and share with the centers and local boards. This workspace includes a facility list with contact information, voting packet amounts, and all peripherals including forms, informational resources, and video. This was a helpful improvement for everyone involved.

Contractual Staffing for Election

The SBE Election Judge train the trainer program has been reviewed by core SBE staff, who provided valuable feedback in effort to continue to improve and evolve the program. The first round of train the trainer classes is scheduled to begin on February 17. After successfully completing the program, trainers will be deployed to Baltimore County, Charles & Frederick. This will be followed by the next round of local board training sessions.

Transportation for Election

SBE has conducted the kickoff meeting with the transportation team. Local board transportation meetings will begin in late March. The meetings will cover logistical details of the voting system transportation to polling places and early voting locations.

Language Assistance Implementation:

Anne Arundel County, Baltimore City, Baltimore County, Montgomery County, and Prince George's County will provide language assistance in 2026 under the new state law. These counties will have signage and an interpretation service, Language Line Solutions, available at polling places, and translated voter registration and absentee ballot applications and voter guides posted to their websites. The counties are also making efforts to recruit bilingual Election Judges. If LBEs want to provide additional documents or help in more languages, they will submit a request using a form prescribed by SBE.

Information Systems & Technology

Applications

Release 10.6 of MDVOTERS will be deployed on April 10, 2026. This release will be the last release before the primary election. The release will focus on enhancements of web delivery reporting and cure letter updates.

Information Security

Cyber Awareness

As the election nears, the cybersecurity team wants to put more emphasis on phishing attempts from bad actors as the phishing emails and texts are becoming more frequent and complex.

Mail-In Voting (MIV)

To address the ongoing concerns regarding postmarks, SBE is drafting enhanced language for Mail-In Voter materials that will 1.) emphasize that voters should return their ballot as early as possible; 2.) Alert voters that some USPS postmarks may be dated 1-2 days after the day the voter mails their ballot. To ensure their ballot is postmarked on or before Election Day, voters should request a hand-stamped postmark at a USPS facility and; 3.) recommend that voters in Maryland can use official ballot drop boxes. Ballots in drop boxes are retrieved by election officials at least daily, and drop boxes remain open until 8pm on Election Day

Personnel Management

Human Resources passed their DBM recruitment audit. Charles County is interviewing to fill their Deputy Director position. Many recruitments are being posted on behalf of the LBEs.

Procurement

Active Procurements

- 1.) *The New Voting System (NVS):* RFP D38B5600001 was published on June 27, 2025. On September 5, 2025 SBE received 4 offers in response to the solicitation. One Offeror withdrew their proposal. The RFP is planned for deployment in the 2028 election. The BAFO process will be underway this week. SBE sent an intent to award on February 3, 2026 to the Offeror unanimously selected by the evaluation committee as the top choice for Maryland. State Certification and debriefings of non-selected Offerors are currently underway.
- 2.) *Managed Security Services: RFP D38B6600005-* The MSS RFP for a managed security services provider was submitted for DoIT review in late January, 2026. The purpose of this solicitation is to procure a security contract that strengthens the agency's cybersecurity operations, engineering capabilities, and enterprise risk management. The selected contractor will provide managed security operations, specialized engineering expertise, and strategic advisory services to support the continued maturation of the agency's Cyber Security Division.
- 3.) *MDVOTERS V Data Center: RFP D38B6600007-* The MDVOTERS V hosting services RFP is in the final development stages. The purpose of this contract is for Data Center (DC) hosting services, including hardware for several election systems, network administration, and DC migration/relocation services, and a managed services provider for the data centers. The primary DC is also referred to as the Voter Registration Operations Center (VROC) throughout this document. Additionally requirements include the management and operations of the Continuity of Operations Center (COOP) data center.

Recent Awards:

- 1.) Statewide Pollbook Modernization: BPW approved SBE's pollbook award on 12/3/2025. The contract started on January 15, 2026.
- 2.) Voter Registration Applications: It has come to SBE's attention that the printing of the VRAs (by Taylor Print and Visual Impressions) does not meet the required standards provided in the solicitation. SBE is in the process of remedying the issue so please be on the lookout for new VRAs.
- 3.) Other supply orders made through MCE for you to please confirm delivery receipt:
 - a.) I Voted Stickers
 - b.) Orange Provisional Bags
 - c.) Yellow Absentee Bags

Requests for Information:

- 1.) Automated Ballot Tabulation Audit Contract: An RFI for information on additional vendor options for the Clear Ballot contract to determine if this is still a sole source or if other vendors have entered the marketplace was posted on eMMA on January 15, 2026. Responses are due on February 13, 2026.

Voter Registration, Audits & Operations

Internal Audits

Monthly audits of voter registration data continue to verify compliance with federal and state laws governing voter registration.

Critical Data Oversight Review

Two virtual sessions were held to review and train local board staff members on the requirements and procedures for this required review of their peers. Both sessions were well attended and seemed to be well received and useful.

Election Operations

The Election Operations has finalized the Election Judge, Same Day Registration, and Address Change Manuals for the 2026 election cycle and provided these to all local boards of elections. We are in the process of reviewing each LBE's customization of manuals and forms so that they are compliant and standardized. We continue to track election judge recruitment, pay rates, and training schedules in preparation for the 2026 Gubernatorial Primary.

We continue to work with *Voting Works* and LBE stakeholders to implement Risk Limiting Audits for the upcoming 2026 election cycle in congruence with SB 313 (2025). This audit will replace the manual audit and complement our automated tabulation audit by verifying the outcome of the election prior to state certification.

Registration & Election Management Database (MDVOTERS)

ERIC Reports for January were received.

NCOA (National Change of Address): 114,657

Cross State: 13,085
In State Update: 44,879

The current total active registered voters as of February 9, 2026 was 4,308,629.

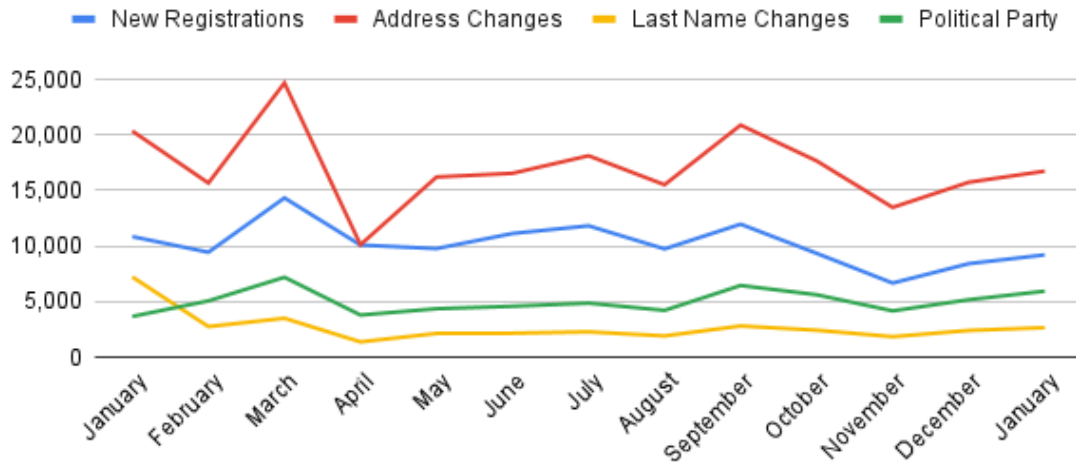
Motor Vehicle Administration (MVA) Transactions

During January 2026, MVA collected the following voter registration transactions:

New Registration - 9,201 Residential Address Changes - 16,735
Last Name Changes - 2,651 Political Party - 5,935

Last 13 Months of MVA Transactions - Chart:

MVA Transactions January 2025 to January 2026



MVA Transactions - Monthly Changes:

	New Registrations	Address Changes	Last Name	Political Party
Dec-2025				
Month-to-Month - Change	26.2%	16.8%	30.4%	24.2%
Same Month - Previous Year Change	1.3%	4.1%	-24.3%	-12.9%
Same Month - 2 Years Ago Change	8.7%	25.3%	14.4%	30.2%
Jan-2026				
Month-to-Month - Change	9.4%	6.4%	10.5%	14.9%

Same Month - Previous Year Change	-15.2%	-17.7%	-63.2%	62.1%
Same Month - 2 Years Ago Change	4.8%	-29.2%	-24.0%	8.3%

MSR- Removals

Maryland Board of Elections Voter Registration Activity Report January 2026

REMOVALS									
	DEM	REP	GRN	WCP	UNA	OTH	UNAF	OTH	TOTAL
BOARD ACTION	0	0	0	0	0	0			0
CONFIRMATION MAIL	28	9	0	0	8	1			46
COUNTY TRANSFER - OUT	3265	1143	11	8	1504	117			6,048
CRIMINAL CONVICTION	1	0	0	0	1	0			2
DEATH NOTICE	1809	1009	1	4	438	35			3,296
DUPLICATE	76	16	0	0	30	5			127
MAIL VERIFICATION (NVRA)	523	294	3	1	369	28			1,218
MENTAL INCOMPETENCY	0	1	0	0	0	0			1
MOVED OUT OF STATE	298	207	1	1	148	11			666
OTHER	28	9	1	0	31	5			74
VOTER REQUEST	59	38	1	0	53	3			154
TOTAL	6,087	2,726	18	14	2,582	205		0	11,632

Exercise of Delegated Duties

We will use this section of the State Administrator's Report to report when we have exercised duties assigned to the State Board of Elections but delegated to the State Administrator and staff.

Since the last State Administrator's Report:

☒ No delegated duties were exercised.

☐ The following delegated duties were exercised.